Arabic 011: Lesson 4 Study Guide

Everything for the Thursday, Nov 5 quiz in one place.

Contents

- Vocabulary from p. 52, with plurals
- The verbal sentence
- The present tense and negation with لا
- Verb forms (awzaan) of three-consonant verbs
- Hamzat al-qaTʿ and hamzat al-waSl
- Hollow verbs: نام، سار، قال، كان
- كانَ in the past, all persons

The Rules at a Glance

- The present tense: prefix by person (أ ت ي ن) and suffix by number and gender. Negate it with لا directly before the verb; the verb does not change.
- A verbal sentence starts with the verb. When the verb comes **before** its subject it is **singular** (agreeing only in gender), even if the subject is plural: يَدْرُسُ الطُّلّابُ.
- When the subject comes **first** the sentence is nominal and the verb agrees fully: الطُّلّابُ يَدْرُسُونَ.
- To change a nominal sentence into a verbal one: move the verb to the front, make it singular, and keep the gender of the subject.
- Hamzat al-waSl is not pronounced after a vowel: ال, اثْنان، امْرأة، ابْنة، ابْن، اسْم, and the past of Forms VII to X. Test: put و before the word. Hamzat al-qaTʿ is always heard (إِلَى، أَنا، أُخْت, Form IV).
- Hollow verbs: the middle weak letter is a long vowel in the present (يَنامُ، يَسيرُ، يَقولُ، يَكونُ) and in the past before a vowel ending (نامَتْ، قالُوا). It shortens before a consonant ending: نِمْتُ، سِرْتُ، قُلْتُ، كُنْتُ، كُنَّ.
- كانَ turns a nominal sentence into the past: subject nominative, predicate accusative: كانَ الطَّقْسُ بارِداً.

Vocabulary

Nouns

school *madrasa*	مَدرَسة
classmate, colleague, m. *zamiil*	زَميل
classmate, colleague, f. *zamiila*	زَميلة
traveling (noun) *as-safar (ilaa)*	السَّفَر (إلى)
friend, f. *Sadiiqa*	صَديقة
friend, m. *Sadiiq*	صَديق
childhood *aT-Tufuula*	الطُّفولة
individual, person *fard*	فَرد
schools *madaaris*	مَدارِس
classmates, colleagues, m. *zumalaa'*	زُمَلاء
classmates, colleagues, f. *zamiilaat*	زَميلات
friends, f. *Sadiiqaat*	صَديقات
friends, m. *aSdiqaa'*	أَصْدِقاء
individuals, people *afraad*	أَفْراد

Verbs

I memorize *aHfaZ*	أحفَظ
I remember *atadhakkar*	أتَذَكَّر
she travels *tusaafir (ilaa)*	تُسافِر (إلى)
he was *kaana*	كانَ
I was *kuntu*	كُنتُ

Adjectives

primary, elementary *ibtidaa'iyy*	ابتِدائيّ

Numbers

first *awwal*	أوَّل	fourth *raabiʿ*	رابِع

Other

before *qabla*	قَبلَ	all, every *kull*	كُلّ

The Verbal Sentence

A verbal sentence (الجُملة الفِعلِيّة) starts with a conjugated verb.

Word order: verb first

The verb comes before the subject: يَدرُسُ أحمد التاريخ (Ahmad studies history), literally "studies Ahmad the-history." With the subject first (أحمد يَدرُسُ التاريخ) the sentence is nominal, with a different emphasis: "as for Ahmad, he studies history."

Agreement

When the verb comes first, before its subject, the verb stays SINGULAR even if the subject that follows is plural. يَدرُسُ الطُلّابُ العَربِيّة (the students study Arabic) uses the singular يَدرُسُ, not the plural يَدرُسون. With the subject first, the verb agrees in number: الطُلّابُ يَدرُسونَ العَربِيّة.

Negating a verbal sentence

Negate present-tense verbs with لا before the verb: لا يَدرُسُ أحمد التاريخ (Ahmad doesn't study history).

Present tense meaning

Arabic has no separate progressive: the present tense covers both "works" and "is working."

Present-Tense Verb Conjugation

How the present tense is built

The present tense (al-mudaariʿ) wraps the verb root in prefixes and suffixes that mark person, gender, and number. Nearly all verbs use the same prefixes and suffixes.

Full paradigm: shaahada (to watch)

Pronoun	Meaning	Form
	I	أُشَاهِدُ
	you (m. sg.)	تُشَاهِدُ
	you (f. sg.)	تُشَاهِدِينَ
	he	يُشَاهِدُ
	she	تُشَاهِدُ

نُشَاهِدُ	we	
تُشَاهِدَانِ	you (dual)	
يُشَاهِدَانِ	they (m. dual)	
تُشَاهِدَانِ	they (f. dual)	
تُشَاهِدُونَ	you (m. pl.)	
تُشَاهِدْنَ	you (f. pl.)	
يُشَاهِدُونَ	they (m. pl.)	
يُشَاهِدْنَ	they (f. pl.)	

The underlying pattern

- Prefix by person: أ- for "I," ت- for "you" and for "she," ي- for "he" and for "they" (masculine), ن- for "we."
- Suffix by number and gender: nothing extra for the plain singular forms, ـِينَ for "you, feminine singular," ـَانِ for both dual forms, ـُونَ for "you/they, masculine plural," and ـْنَ for "you/they, feminine plural."

Other verbs use the same prefixes and suffixes; only the stem vowel varies:

Verb	Meaning	I" form"	he" form"
dhahaba	to go	أَذْهَب	يَذْهَب
shariba	to drink	أَشْرَب	يَشْرَب
ʿamila	to do, to work	أَعْمَل	يَعْمَل
araada	to want	أُرِيد	يُرِيد
aHabba	to like, to love	أُحِبّ	يُحِبّ

Negating the present tense

Negate with لا directly before the verb. The verb does not change.

لا أَذْهَبُ إلى الجَامِعَةِ اليَوْم (I'm not going to the university today). هُوَ لا يَشْرَبُ القَهْوَة (he doesn't drink coffee).

The Verbs and Their Forms

Every verb in the course, with its form number (wazn).

Meaning	Form	Past (huwa)	Present (ana)	Present (huwa)
to accept	I	قَبِلَ	أَقْبَلُ	يَقْبَلُ
to do, to work	I	عَمِلَ	أَعْمَلُ	يَعْمَلُ
to drink	I	شَرِبَ	أَشْرَبُ	يَشْرَبُ
to eat	I	أَكَلَ	آكُلُ	يَأْكُلُ
to go	I	ذَهَبَ	أَذْهَبُ	يَذْهَبُ
to know	I	عَرَفَ	أَعْرِفُ	يَعْرِفُ
to live	I	سَكَنَ	أَسْكُنُ	يَسْكُنُ

to memorize	I	حَفِظَ	أَحْفَظُ	يَحْفَظُ
to read	I	قَرَأَ	أَقْرَأُ	يَقْرَأُ
to study	I	دَرَسَ	أَدْرُسُ	يَدْرُسُ
to understand	I	فَهِمَ	أَفْهَمُ	يَفْهَمُ
to write	I	كَتَبَ	أَكْتُبُ	يَكْتُبُ
to teach	II	دَرَّسَ	أُدَرِّسُ	يُدَرِّسُ
to travel	III	سَافَرَ	أُسَافِرُ	يُسَافِرُ
to watch	III	شَاهَدَ	أُشَاهِدُ	يُشَاهِدُ
to love, to like	IV	أَحَبَّ	أُحِبُّ	يُحِبُّ
to send	IV	أَرْسَلَ	أُرْسِلُ	يُرْسِلُ
to want	IV	أَرَادَ	أُرِيدُ	يُرِيدُ
to get married, to marry	V	تَزَوَّجَ	أَتَزَوَّجُ	يَتَزَوَّجُ
to remember	V	تَذَكَّرَ	أَتَذَكَّرُ	يَتَذَكَّرُ
to speak	V	تَكَلَّمَ	أَتَكَلَّمُ	يَتَكَلَّمُ
to specialize in	V	تَخَصَّصَ	أَتَخَصَّصُ	يَتَخَصَّصُ
to listen	VIII	اسْتَمَعَ	أَسْتَمِعُ	يَسْتَمِعُ
to translate	quad.	تَرْجَمَ	أُتَرْجِمُ	يُتَرْجِمُ

Verb Forms (al-Awzaan)

Derived verbs follow ten numbered patterns, called forms or أوزان (awzaan, "weights" or "measures"). Each form puts the same root in a different template and gives a related meaning. Examples: شاهَدَ (Form III), أراد and أَحَبَّ (Form IV), تَكَلَّمَ and تَذَكَّرَ (Form V).

Typical meanings

The shape of a form shows the root and often the meaning relative to Form I: Form II often makes a verb causative (دَرَسَ "he studied" → دَرَّسَ "he taught," literally "he caused to study"), Form III often implies doing something with or to another person (سافَرَ, "to travel," implies going somewhere involving others or a destination), and Form V is very often the reflexive of Form II (تَعَلَّمَ "to learn," the reflexive counterpart of عَلَّمَ "to teach").

The ten forms, past tense (huwa) and present tense (huwa)

Form	Past	Present
I	فَعَلَ	يَفْعَلُ
II	فَعَّلَ	يُفَعِّلُ
III	فاعَلَ	يُفاعِلُ
IV	أَفْعَلَ	يُفْعِلُ

V	تَفَعَّلَ	يَتَفَعَّلُ
VI	تَفاعَلَ	يَتَفاعَلُ
VII	اِنفَعَلَ	يَنفَعِلُ
VIII	اِفتَعَلَ	يَفتَعِلُ
IX	اِفعَلَّ	يَفعَلُّ
X	اِستَفعَلَ	يَستَفعِلُ

Form IX is rare (mostly colors and physical defects). Forms VII, VIII, and X are common. اِسْتَمَعَ ("to listen") is Form VIII: the اِفْتَعَلَ template with root س-م-ع.

Hamza: Qatʿ and Waṣl

What hamza is

Hamza (ء) is a glottal stop, the catch in the middle of "uh-oh." It is not counted among the 28 letters and has no fixed shape: it sits on or under a "seat" letter, or alone on the line.

Form	When it's used
أ	hamza on an alif seat, carrying a fatHa or Damma
إ	hamza under an alif seat, carrying a kasra
ؤ	hamza on a waaw seat
ئ	hamza on a dotless yaa seat
ء	hamza alone on the line, with no seat

The seat depends mostly on the strongest neighboring vowel: kasra pulls in a yaa seat, Damma a waaw seat, fatHa an alif seat. At the start of a word hamza is always on an alif (أ or إ).

Hamzat al-qaTʿ: the "cutting" hamza

- Written as a hamza sitting on an alif: أ إ أُ
- Always pronounced and always heard, no matter what comes before it in the sentence.
- Example: أُخْت (ukht, "sister").

Hamzat al-waSl: the "connecting" hamza

- Written as a plain alif, sometimes marked with a small ص (waSla) sign on top to flag it explicitly: ٱ or simply ا with no hamza mark at all.
- Elided: after a word ending in a vowel, the hamza and its vowel are not pronounced.
- Found at the start of: the definite article ال, a handful of common nouns (اسم "name," ابن "son," ابنة "daughter," امرأة "woman," اثنان "two"), and certain verb forms: the past tense of Forms VII to X (اِنْفَعَلَ، اِفْتَعَلَ، اِفْعَلَّ، اِسْتَفْعَلَ, for example اِسْتَمَعَ) starts with hamzat al-waSl, while Form IV (أَفْعَلَ, for example أَرادَ) starts with hamzat al-qaTʿ.

Test: put و ("and") or ف ("so") before the word. If the hamza disappears it is hamzat al-waSl; if you still hear it, it is hamzat al-qaTʿ.

وَأَب (wa-ab): the hamza is still heard, so this is hamzat al-qaTʿ.
وَالبَيْت (wa-l-bayt): the alif's hamza disappears and the ل is pronounced directly after wa, so this is hamzat al-waSl.

Alif madda (آ)

Alif madda is a hamza-alif followed by a long alif, written as one alif with a wavy line above and pronounced as a long "aa."

Taa marbuuTa (ة)

Taa marbuuTa appears only at the end of a noun or adjective and usually marks it as feminine. It is pronounced "-a" on its own and "-at" when something follows: a possessive suffix, or when the word is the first noun of an idafa.

طَالِبَة (Taaliba, "a student") ("-a") versus طَالِبَةُ الجَامِعَة (Taalibatu l-jaamiʿa, "the university's student") ("-at").

Hollow and Irregular Verbs

A hollow verb (الفِعل الأجوَف) has a weak letter, و or ي, as its middle root consonant; the weak letter changes depending on what follows it.

Four common hollow and irregular verbs

Meaning	Past (huwa)	Present (huwa)
to sleep	نامَ	يَنامُ
to walk, go, move, travel	سارَ	يَسيرُ
to say	قالَ	يَقولُ
to be	كانَ	يَكونُ

The middle letter shows up as a long vowel in the present tense (aa, ii, or uu, depending on the verb) and shortens before a consonant-initial suffix such as the feminine plural ـنَ.

Past tense with pronouns

Before an ending that starts with a consonant (ـتُ، ـتَ، ـنا، ـنَ) the long vowel shortens and the weak letter drops out: kasra for نامَ and سارَ, Damma for قالَ and كانَ. The long vowel stays before a vowel ending (نامَتْ، نامُوا).

Pronoun	نامَ	سارَ	قالَ	كانَ
أَنا	نِمْتُ	سِرْتُ	قُلْتُ	كُنْتُ
أَنْتَ	نِمْتَ	سِرْتَ	قُلْتَ	كُنْتَ
هُوَ	نامَ	سارَ	قالَ	كانَ
هِيَ	نامَتْ	سارَتْ	قالَتْ	كانَتْ
نَحْنُ	نِمْنا	سِرْنا	قُلْنا	كُنّا
هُمْ	نامُوا	سارُوا	قالُوا	كانُوا
هُنَّ	نِمْنَ	سِرْنَ	قُلْنَ	كُنَّ

Present tense with pronouns

The long vowel stays everywhere except هُنَّ, where it shortens before ـنَ.

Pronoun	يَنامُ	يَسيرُ	يَقولُ	يَكونُ
أَنا	أَنامُ	أَسيرُ	أَقولُ	أَكونُ

تَكونُ	تَقولُ	تَسيرُ	تَنامُ	أَنْتَ
يَكونُ	يَقولُ	يَسيرُ	يَنامُ	هُوَ
تَكونُ	تَقولُ	تَسيرُ	تَنامُ	هِيَ
نَكونُ	نَقولُ	نَسيرُ	نَنامُ	نَحْنُ
يَكونُونَ	يَقولُونَ	يَسيرُونَ	يَنامُونَ	هُمْ
يَكُنَّ	يَقُلْنَ	يَسِرْنَ	يَنَمْنَ	هُنَّ

kaana

كانَ is the closest thing Arabic has to a past-tense "to be." It turns a nominal sentence into a statement about the past: كانَ الطَّقسُ بارِداً (the weather was cold). Just like with لَيسَ, the predicate after كان is accusative in fully vowelled Arabic (بارِداً, not بارِدٌ).

Kaana

كانَ (was): past tense

كانَ	Pronoun
كُنْتُ	أَنا
كُنْتَ	أَنْتَ
كُنْتِ	أَنْتِ
كانَ	هُوَ
كانَتْ	هِيَ
كُنْتُما	أَنْتُما
كانا	هُما (.m)
كانَتا	هُما (.f)
كُنّا	نَحْنُ
كُنْتُمْ	أَنْتُمْ
كُنْتُنَّ	أَنْتُنَّ
كانُوا	هُمْ
كُنَّ	هُنَّ

- The endings are the past-tense endings: ـتُ، ـتَ، ـتِ، ـتُما، ـتُمْ، ـتُنَّ، ـنا، ـنَ.
- The long vowel shortens before an ending that starts with a consonant: كانَ but كُنْتُ, كُنّا, كُنَّ.
- Subject nominative, predicate accusative: كانَ الطَّقْسُ جَمِيلاً. A prepositional predicate stays as it is: كانَتْ فِي المَكْتَبِ.
- With a subject that follows, the verb agrees in gender only and stays singular: كانَ الطُّلّابُ فِي الصَّفِّ. A plural of things takes the feminine singular: كانَتِ البُيُوتُ قَدِيمَةً.

Self-Check

Cover the right column and answer, then check.

A. Say it in Arabic

Lesson 4 vocabulary.

school	مَدْرَسة
primary, elementary	اِبْتِدائِيّ
classmate (m.)	زَمِيل
classmate (f.)	زَمِيلة
friend (m.)	صَدِيق
friend (f.)	صَدِيقة
childhood	الطُّفُولة
individual, person	فَرْد
before	قَبْلَ
all, every	كُلّ
first	أَوَّل
fourth	رابِع
traveling	السَّفَر (إِلَى)
I memorize	أَحْفَظ
I remember	أَتَذَكَّر
she travels	تُسافِر (إِلَى)
he was	كانَ
I was	كُنْتُ

B. Give the plural

مَدْرَسة	مَدارِس
زَمِيل	زُمَلاء
زَمِيلة	زَمِيلات
صَدِيق	أَصْدِقاء
صَدِيقة	صَدِيقات
فَرْد	أَفْراد

C. Present tense

Write the present-tense form for the pronoun.

أَذْهَبُ	(ذَهَبَ / أَنا)
تَكْتُبُ	(كَتَبَ / أَنْتَ)
يَشْرَبُ	(شَرِبَ / هُوَ)
تُسافِرُ	(سافَرَ / هِيَ)
نَعْمَلُ	(عَمِلَ / نَحْنُ)
تَحْفَظُونَ	(حَفِظَ / أَنْتُمْ)
يَتَذَكَّرُونَ	(تَذَكَّرَ / هُمْ)
آكُلُ	(أَكَلَ / أَنا)
أُدَرِّسُ	(دَرَّسَ / أَنا)
تَفْهَمِينَ	(فَهِمَ / أَنْتِ)

D. Say no

Negate each sentence with لا.

أَنا لا أَذْهَبُ إِلَى المَدْرَسةِ.	أَنا أَذْهَبُ إِلَى المَدْرَسةِ.
هِيَ لا تُسافِرُ إِلَى القاهِرةِ.	هِيَ تُسافِرُ إِلَى القاهِرةِ.
لا يَحْفَظُ الطُّلّابُ الأَسْماءَ.	يَحْفَظُ الطُّلّابُ الأَسْماءَ.
نَحْنُ لا نَتَذَكَّرُ الطُّفُولةَ.	نَحْنُ نَتَذَكَّرُ الطُّفُولةَ.
لا تَدْرُسُ زَمِيلَتِي فِي المَدْرَسةِ.	تَدْرُسُ زَمِيلَتِي فِي المَدْرَسةِ.

E. Make it a verbal sentence

Put the verb first. The verb is singular when it comes before its subject.

يَدْرُسُ الطُّلّابُ العَرَبِيّةَ.	الطُّلّابُ يَدْرُسُونَ العَرَبِيّةَ.
تَكْتُبُ الطّالِباتُ الرِّسالةَ.	الطّالِباتُ يَكْتُبْنَ الرِّسالةَ.
يَذْهَبُ الأَصْدِقاءُ إِلَى المَدْرَسةِ.	الأَصْدِقاءُ يَذْهَبُونَ إِلَى المَدْرَسةِ.
تَقْرَأُ الزَّمِيلةُ القِصّةَ.	الزَّمِيلةُ تَقْرَأُ القِصّةَ.
يَعْمَلُ المُوَظَّفُونَ فِي البَنْكِ.	المُوَظَّفُونَ يَعْمَلُونَ فِي البَنْكِ.

F. Which form is it?

Give the form number (wazn) of each past-tense verb.

شاهَدَ	III (فاعَلَ)
أَرادَ	IV (أَفْعَلَ)

دَرَّسَ	II (فَعَّلَ)
تَذَكَّرَ	V (تَفَعَّلَ)
سافَرَ	III (فاعَلَ)
أَرْسَلَ	IV (أَفْعَلَ)
اِسْتَمَعَ	VIII (اِفْتَعَلَ)
كَتَبَ	I (فَعَلَ)

G. Qatʿ or waSl?

Is the hamza at the start of the word hamzat al-qaTʿ or hamzat al-waSl?

أُخْت	qaTʿ (always pronounced)
اِسْم	waSl
الكِتاب	waSl (the definite article)
أَنا	qaTʿ
اِبْن	waSl
إِلَى	qaTʿ
اِسْتَمَعَ	waSl (Form VIII)
أَرادَ	qaTʿ (Form IV)

H. Hollow verbs

Write the form asked for.

نِمْتُ	(past ،نامَ / أَنا)
سارَتْ	(past ،سارَ / هِيَ)
قُلْتُ	(past ،قالَ / أَنا)
كُنّا	(past ،كانَ / نَحْنُ)
كُنَّ	(past ،كانَ / هُنَّ)
قالُوا	(past ،قالَ / هُمْ)
أَنامُ	(present ،نامَ / أَنا)
يَسيرُ	(present ،سارَ / هُوَ)
نَقولُ	(present ،قالَ / نَحْنُ)
تَكونُ	(present ،كانَ / أَنْتَ)
يَقُلْنَ	(present ،قالَ / هُنَّ)

I. Use kaana

Say the sentence in the past with كان.

الطَّقْسُ بارِدٌ.	كانَ الطَّقْسُ بارِداً.
المَدْرَسةُ كَبِيرةٌ.	كانَتِ المَدْرَسةُ كَبِيرةً.
أَنا طالِبٌ.	كُنْتُ طالِباً.
نَحْنُ طُلّابٌ.	كُنّا طُلّاباً.
أَصْدِقائِي فِي المَدْرَسةِ.	كانَ أَصْدِقائِي فِي المَدْرَسةِ.